

## WEEK 13 / FUTURE DIRECTIONS AND SYNTHESIS

# Virtual Reality, AI, and the Future of Gaming

**The role of XR and AI in creating lifelike environments.**

This week, we explore the role of virtual reality (VR), augmented reality (AR), mixed reality (MR), and artificial intelligence (AI) in creating immersive and lifelike gaming environments. We will discuss the technological advancements and their impact on player experience.

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23 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC

## TOPIC 01

## Immersive Technology and AI

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**REQUIRED****Video game performers are on strike - and AI is the sticking point**

ARTICLE/AUDIO | ~12 MIN

<https://www.npr.org/2024/08/02/1198912993/video-games-ai-artificial-intelligence-warner-bros-strike>

LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.

LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.

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LO 8: Students will be able to discuss potential future trends in gaming, reflecting on emerging technologies, cultural shifts, and player expectations.

**REQUIRED****SAG-AFTRA receives bipartisan congressional support for anti-deepfake and AI act**

ARTICLE | ~3 MIN

[https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/sag-aftra-receives-congress-bipartisan-support-for-anti-deepfake-and-ai-act?sp\\_a\\_id=129083&elq\\_cid=48662221&sp\\_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp\\_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm\\_source=eloqua&utm\\_medium=email&utm\\_campaign=Gama\\_NL\\_Game%20Developer%20Daily\\_04.10.25&sp\\_cid=57510&utm\\_content=Gama\\_NL\\_Game%20Developer%20Daily\\_04.10.25](https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/sag-aftra-receives-congress-bipartisan-support-for-anti-deepfake-and-ai-act?sp_a_id=129083&elq_cid=48662221&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm_source=eloqua&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_04.10.25&sp_cid=57510&utm_content=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_04.10.25)

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#### REQUIRED

## Report: Candy Crush maker King is allegedly replacing laid off employees with AI tools

ARTICLE | ~3 MIN

[https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/report-candy-crush-maker-king-is-allegedly-replacing-employees-with-internal-ai-tools?mc=Gama\\_NL18072025&cid=Gama\\_NL18072025&sp\\_aid=130745&elq\\_cid=48662221&sp\\_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp\\_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm\\_source=eloqua&utm\\_medium=email&utm\\_campaign=Gama\\_NL\\_Game%20Developer%20Daily\\_07.18.25&sp\\_cid=58704&utm\\_content=Gama\\_NL\\_Game%20Developer%20Daily\\_07.18.25](https://www.gamedeveloper.com/business/report-candy-crush-maker-king-is-allegedly-replacing-employees-with-internal-ai-tools?mc=Gama_NL18072025&cid=Gama_NL18072025&sp_aid=130745&elq_cid=48662221&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm_source=eloqua&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_07.18.25&sp_cid=58704&utm_content=Gama_NL_Game%20Developer%20Daily_07.18.25)

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#### REQUIRED

## History of AI in Games - Video Game - F.E.A.R

BLOG POST WITH 2 YOUTUBE VIDEOS | ~25 MIN

<https://modl.ai/fear/>

LO 5: Students will gain insights into how technologies like artificial intelligence, virtual reality, and online connectivity shape gaming experiences.

#### REQUIRED

## The Darth Vader Fortnite AI DISASTER

YOUTUBE | ~12 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Gfcpb-sKvUg>

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#### REQUIRED

## VR and AI in Education: The Future of Learning

TED TALK | ~13 MIN

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XGkWh4v1hCE&ab\\_channel=TEDxTalks](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XGkWh4v1hCE&ab_channel=TEDxTalks)

LO 3: Students will explore the applications of video games beyond entertainment, including their use in medicine, education, and social engagement.

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## REQUIRED

### Philip Rosedale: Second Life, where anything is possible

TED TALK | ~29 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IHXXsEtE3b4>

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## REQUIRED

### How immersive technologies (AR/VR) will shape our future

TED TALK | ~13 MIN

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QcANba\\_1xg8&ab\\_channel=TEDxTalks](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QcANba_1xg8&ab_channel=TEDxTalks)

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## REQUIRED

### Immersive Gaming! | Imp And Skizz Podcast (Ep82), especially the first 4 minutes

PODCAST/YOUTUBE | 4 MIN - 55 MIN

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KEuuscx1VTY&ab\\_channel=ImpAndSkizzPodcast](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KEuuscx1VTY&ab_channel=ImpAndSkizzPodcast)

LO 1: Students will be able to explain the historical development of video games, from early arcade games to contemporary digital gaming platforms.

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## REQUIRED

### A Gamer Looks At 40 Ep 117: Side Quests Vol 9, from 1:20 to 7:20

PODCAST CLIP | ~6 MIN

<https://www.buzzsprout.com/1426576/episodes/15949708?t=80>

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## REQUIRED

### Interactivity in immersive spaces : an art & tech journey

**YOUTUBE | ~33 MIN**

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a65TW9toG-E&ab\\_channel=Augmenta](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a65TW9toG-E&ab_channel=Augmenta)

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#### EXPLORE FURTHER

### Ready Player One by Ernest Cline

**BOOK**

[https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE\\_INST/2sp9f6/alma991008066629708681](https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/2sp9f6/alma991008066629708681)

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

### Ready Player One

**MOVIE**

[https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE\\_INST/2sp9f6/alma991023937949708681](https://maine.primo.exlibrisgroup.com/permalink/01MAINE_INST/2sp9f6/alma991023937949708681)

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

### Three States and a Plan: The A.I. of F.E.A.R. by Jeff Orkin

**ACADEMIC PAPER**

<https://www.gamedevs.org/uploads/three-states-plan-ai-of-fear.pdf>

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

### Best AI in Video Games Review

**BLOG POST**

<https://vanceai.com/posts/best-ai-in-video-games-review/>

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

### Talking to Smart AI NPCs in Unreal Engine 5 (The Future of Gaming & Artificial Intelligence)

**YOUTUBE | 10 MIN**

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4sCWf2VGdfc&ab\\_channel=TmarTn2](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4sCWf2VGdfc&ab_channel=TmarTn2)

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#### EXPLORE FURTHER

## Igloo Vision Demos Igloo Vision Immersive Space for Education and Enterprise

[YOUTUBE](#) | 3 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-JaXgEEiLbo>

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## Circle of Life / Breathtaking Immersive Experience of Nature and Light

[YOUTUBE](#)

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q3ilOpjMV4&ab\\_channel=Limelight](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Q3ilOpjMV4&ab_channel=Limelight)

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

## Crafting immersive spaces with virtual tracking systems | Naostage booth showcase | ISE 2024

[YOUTUBE](#)

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YBdVPidzILQ&ab\\_channel=Inavate](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=YBdVPidzILQ&ab_channel=Inavate)

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

## I Tried Real Augmented Reality Glasses!

[YOUTUBE](#)

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G0eKzU\\_fv00&ab\\_channel=MarquesBrownlee](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=G0eKzU_fv00&ab_channel=MarquesBrownlee)

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

## Second Life Community Roundtable with Philip Rosedale Replay

[YOUTUBE](#)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1w9al7GcjV8>

#### EXPLORE FURTHER

## How augmented reality will change sports ... and build empathy

[TED TALK](#) | 10 MIN

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AgMOJC5R4F8>

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## EXPLORE FURTHER

### The VR Dilemma: How AR and VR redefine our reality

TED TALK | 14 MIN

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zOBiZrTomso&ab\\_channel=TEDxTalks](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zOBiZrTomso&ab_channel=TEDxTalks)

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